nouez 0.12.0

Architecture and message reference

November 7, 2026

Abstract

nouez is an MCP server that lets Claude Code consult live Codex sessions, and open, list and close Claude Code sessions on the same computer. This document describes nouez 0.12.0: how the pieces fit together, and an example of every message nouez sends or acts on at each boundary: the MCP traffic between Claude Code and nouez, the WebSocket JSON-RPC traffic between nouez and the Codex app-server daemon, the commands nouez runs on the operating system, and its one request to GitHub, which looks for a newer nouez release. The daemon also sends notifications and its own requests, which nouez discards and this document leaves out. Message shapes are as captured in runs with Claude Code 2.1.295 and Codex app-server daemon 0.162.0; client behaviour described here (the discovery probe, progress tokens, the 120-second move to the background) was observed in those runs and is not something nouez controls. Ids are invented, long objects are trimmed to the fields nouez reads, and quoted error texts marked as excerpts are shortened.

Contents

1 Overview **2**

2 Inside the server **3**

3 Claude Code ↔ nouez (MCP) **3**

3.1 Startup . . . 3
3.2 Tool calls and results . . . 5
3.3 Cancellation . . . 6
3.4 Protocol errors . . . 6

4 nouez ↔ Codex daemon **7**

4.1 Connecting . . . 7
4.2 Frames . . . 8
4.3 Message format . . . 8
4.4 Data shapes . . . 8
4.5 Request reference . . . 9
4.6 Finding a session . . . 9

5 Tools, end to end **10**

5.1 StartConsultant . . . 10
5.2 ListConsultants . . . 12
5.3 SendConsultantMessage . . . 13
5.4 GetConsultantReply . . . 16
5.5 GetConsultantHistory . . . 17
5.6 The waiter command . . . 17
5.7 The doctor command . . . 18
5.8 WatchConsultant . . . 18

5.9 StopConsultant 19
5.10 Claude Code sessions 19

6 nouez → operating system **21**
6.1 Opening a pane 21
6.2 Detecting and closing panes 22
6.3 Starting and ending Claude Code sessions 22

7 Limits and constants **23**

1 Overview

Two coding agents look at a problem differently. nouez gives each a fixed role: **Claude Code** is the main developer and owns the work; **Codex** is a consultant that Claude asks for second opinions. Consultants that nouez starts run in a read-only sandbox, and `StartConsultant` only ever reuses those. Claude can also message a Codex session the user opened, by name and with `allow_user_session: true`, when the user asks; such a session keeps the user's own permissions. Everything happens from the single Claude Code terminal.

A message makes three hops (Figure 1):

1. **Claude Code ↔ nouez.** Claude Code starts `server.py` as a child process and speaks MCP to it: JSON-RPC 2.0, one JSON object per line on stdin/stdout.
2. **nouez ↔ Codex daemon.** A tool call that needs the daemon starts `codex app-server proxy` (usually once per call; WatchConsultant may connect twice), which relays its stdio to the daemon's local control socket. Over that pipe nouez performs a WebSocket handshake and then exchanges JSON-RPC messages in WebSocket text frames.
3. **nouez → operating system.** To show a consultant to the user, nouez opens a terminal pane running `codex resume <id>`, which attaches to the same daemon session. It also checks for such panes and, on StopConsultant, tries to close them. The Claude Code session tools work only at this level: they open terminal windows running `claude`, read the files Claude Code keeps about its running sessions, and end processes.

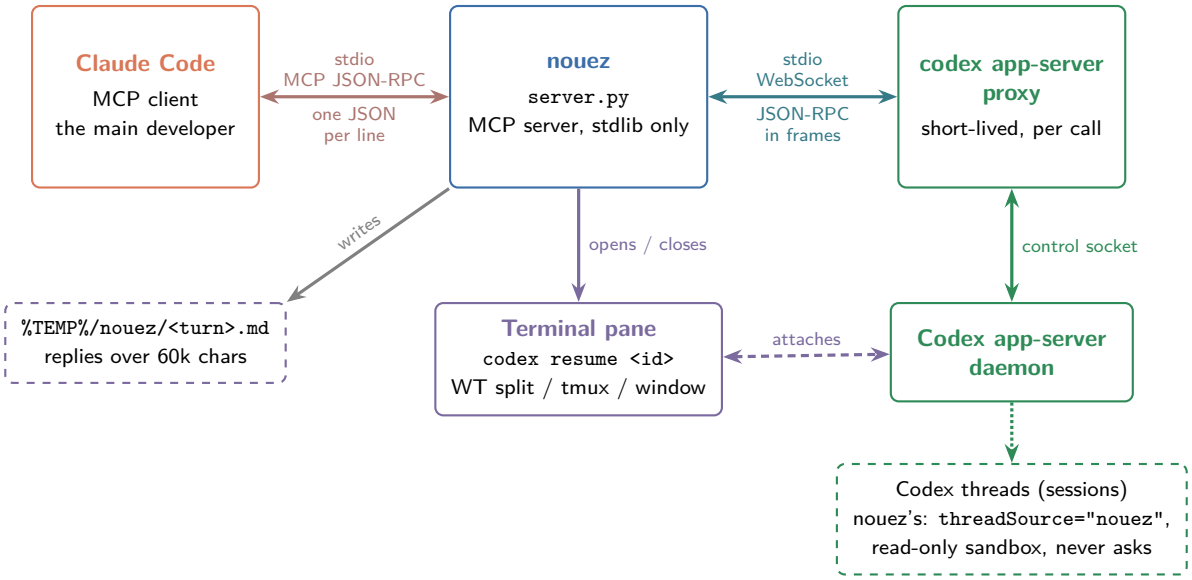


Figure 1: Components and links. Solid arrows carry messages; the terminal pane and nouez share a Codex session through the daemon, not through each other.

	Claude Code ↔ nouez	**nouez ↔ Codex daemon**	**nouez → OS**
Lifetime	whole Claude Code session	short-lived, opened by the tool call	per command
Transport	stdin/stdout of `server.py`	stdio of `codex app-server proxy`	child processes
Framing	newline-delimited JSON	WebSocket frames (RFC 6455)	argv / exit code / stdout
Protocol	MCP (JSON-RPC 2.0)	Codex app-server JSON-RPC (no `"jsonrpc"` field)	`wt`, `tmux`, `osascript`, PowerShell, `pgrep`
Who asks	mostly Claude Code; nouez asks `roots/list`	nouez (daemon requests are discarded)	always nouez
Section	3	4	6

Table 1: The three interfaces.

Three more tools serve a different purpose: they manage Claude Code sessions on the same computer, so that a session driven from the Claude app with Remote Control can start another one in a different project (`OpenClaudeSession`), see which are running (`ListClaudeSessions`) and end a stuck one (`CloseClaudeSession`). They don't involve Codex or talk to Claude Code; they work through the operating system and the files Claude Code keeps (Sections 5.10 and 6.3).

2 Inside the server

`server.py` is a single file using only the Python standard library. One thread reads stdin; every request runs on its own worker thread, because a tool call can block for minutes while Codex works.

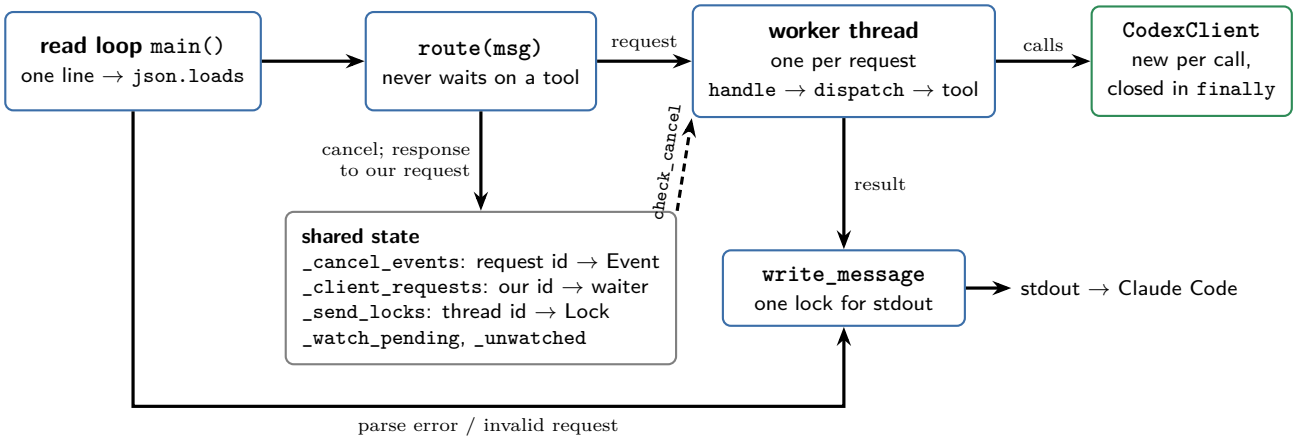


Figure 2: Threading model. Only `write_message` touches stdout, and logs go to stderr, so stdout carries nothing but MCP messages.

`route()` sorts each parsed line:

- Not an object, an `id` that isn't a string or number (booleans included), or a request with `"id": null`: answer `-32600 Invalid Request` right away, from the read loop's thread.
- No `method`: it is Claude Code's answer to a request nouez sent (`roots/list`); wake the waiting thread. Answers nobody is waiting for are dropped.
- `notifications/cancelled`: set the Event of the named request, if it is still running. Malformed params are ignored.
- Anything else: register a cancel Event for `tools/call` before starting its worker thread, so a cancel that arrives while the worker starts up is not lost. (A cancel that arrives before its request has nothing to cancel and is ignored.)

Any exception inside `route()` is logged and the loop continues, so no single line can stop the server. Inside the worker, `handle()` makes sure every request with an id gets a response unless it was cancelled: if `dispatch()` raises, it answers `-32603 Internal error: <exception>`. An exception inside a tool is different: it becomes an `isError` result reading *"Unexpected error: <exception>"*.

3 Claude Code ↔ nouez (MCP)

3.1 Startup

Claude Code 2.1.295 first probes the 2026-07-28 protocol with `server/discover`. nouez is a legacy-lifecycle server, so it answers `-32601`, and Claude Code falls back to the `initialize` handshake with protocol 2025-11-25.

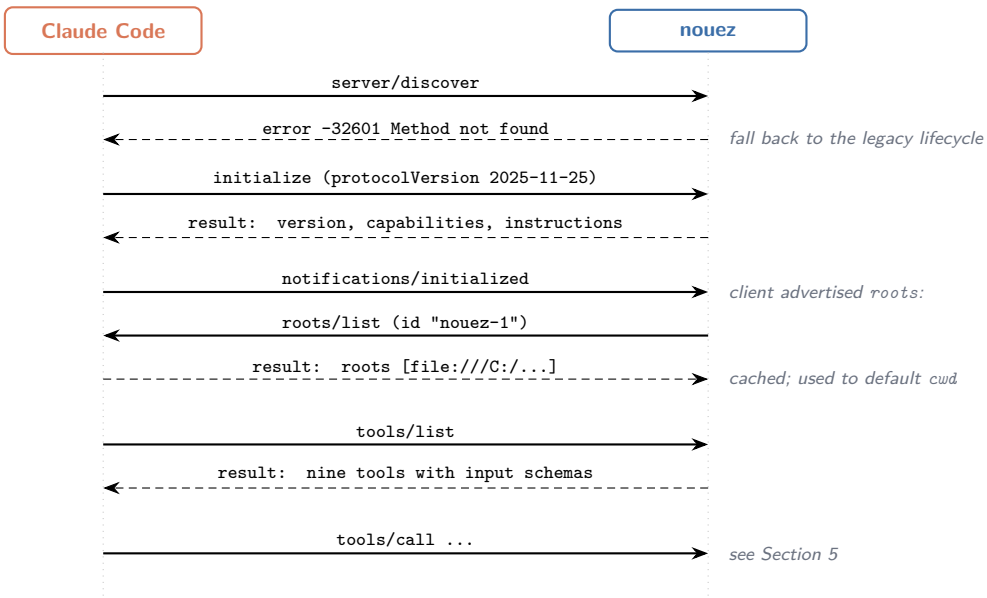


Figure 3: MCP startup.

Claude Code → nouez: discovery probe

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 0, "method": "server/discover", "params": {}}
```

nouez → Claude Code

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 0, "error": {"code": -32601, "message": "Method not found: server/discover"}}
```

Claude Code → nouez: initialize

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 1, "method": "initialize", "params": {
  "protocolVersion": "2025-11-25",
  "capabilities": {"roots": {"listChanged": true}, "elicitation": {"form": {}, "url": {}}},
  "clientInfo": {"name": "claude-code", "version": "2.1.295"}}}
```

nouez answers with the requested version if it supports it (2025-11-25, 2025-06-18 or 2025-03-26) and with 2025-11-25 otherwise. It never echoes an unknown version.

nouez → Claude Code

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 1, "result": {
  "protocolVersion": "2025-11-25",
  "capabilities": {"tools": {}},
  "serverInfo": {"name": "nouez", "version": "0.12.0"},
  "instructions": "Whenever the user asks for a Codex consultant, call StartConsultant with cwd set to your working directory,
     even if you don't remember one being open (earlier context may have been compacted). It reuses a consultant it started
     earlier in this repo, ... A result that says 'still working' is not a reply, even if it shows output so far: never treat it
     as done. Change a consultant's model or reasoning effort ... only when the user asks or the user's own instructions, such as
      their CLAUDE.md, call for it. ..."}}
```

Claude Code → nouez

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "method": "notifications/initialized"}
```

Because Claude Code advertised `roots`, nouez asks for its workspace folders. It does this on a worker thread and waits at most 5 seconds; a client that never answers counts as having no roots. The same request is sent again on `notifications/roots/list_changed`.

nouez → Claude Code: server-initiated request

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": "nouez-1", "method": "roots/list", "params": {}}
```

Claude Code → nouez

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": "nouez-1", "result": {"roots": [
  {"uri": "file:///C:/Users/you/Projects/nouez", "name": "nouez"}]}}
```

Claude Code → nouez

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 2, "method": "tools/list", "params": {}}
```

nouez → Claude Code (one of nine tools shown)

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 2, "result": {"tools": [
  {"name": "SendConsultantMessage",
   "description": "Send a message into a Codex session. By default it waits 5 seconds, enough to confirm delivery and return a
     quick reply; ...",
   "inputSchema": {"type": "object",
     "properties": {
       "to": {"type": "string", "description": "Consultant name, thread id, or unique id prefix/suffix."},
       "message": {"type": "string", "description": "The message to send."},
       "from": {"type": "string", "description": "Sender label shown to Codex, ..."},
       "model": {"type": "string", "description": "Codex model id for this message and later ones, ..."},
       "effort": {"type": "string", "description": "Codex reasoning effort for this message and later ones, ..."},
       "wait": {"anyOf": [{"type": "number", "minimum": 0, "maximum": 14400},
                          {"type": "string", "enum": ["done"]}],
                "description": "How long to wait for the reply: a number of seconds (0 = don't wait), or \"done\" ... Default 5.
     ..."},
       "allow_user_session": {"type": "boolean", "description": "Allow sending to a Codex session the user opened ... Default
     false. ..."}},
     "required": ["to", "message"]},
   "annotations": {"readOnlyHint": false, "destructiveHint": false}},
  ...]}}
```

Each tool carries annotations, hints a client may use when deciding what to confirm:

Tool	readOnlyHint	destructiveHint	also
StartConsultant	false	false	
ListConsultants	true		openWorldHint: false
SendConsultantMessage	false	false	
GetConsultantReply	true*		openWorldHint: false
GetConsultantHistory	true		openWorldHint: false
WatchConsultant	false	false	idempotentHint: true, openWorldHint: false
StopConsultant	false	true	openWorldHint: false
OpenClaudeSession	false	false	openWorldHint: false
ListClaudeSessions	true		openWorldHint: false
CloseClaudeSession	false	true	openWorldHint: false

*Its only write is nouez's own copy of an over-long reply in the temp folder (Section 5.3).

`ping` is answered with an empty result: `{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 9, "result": {}}`.

3.2 Tool calls and results

In the captured runs, every `tools/call` from Claude Code 2.1.295 carried a progress token in `_meta`. Claude Code moved any call that ran past 120 seconds to the background, where its result arrives later as a task notification.

While SendConsultantMessage or GetConsultantReply waits for a running turn, nouez answers a progress token with `notifications/progress`: at most one every 10 seconds, with `progress` counting up from 1 and no `total`, since a turn's length isn't known. The message names the turn, the time waited so far and the latest line of output. None is sent once the call is cancelled, and none without a token. In the runs before 0.4.0, Claude Code did not display progress notifications.

nouez → Claude Code: progress while waiting

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "method": "notifications/progress", "params": {"progressToken": 14, "progress": 3,
  "message": "codex-nouez-4d9f17 is working on turn 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31 (waited 21s): Reading server.py ..."}}
```

Claude Code → nouez: request envelope

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 14, "method": "tools/call", "params": {
  "name": "SendConsultantMessage",
  "arguments": {"to": "codex-nouez-4d9f17", "message": "Review this diff for bugs: ..."},
  "_meta": {"progressToken": 14}}}
```

A tool returns text. Problems the model can act on (a bad argument, an unknown consultant, a daemon that isn't running) come back as a normal result with `isError: true`, so the model reads the message. Requests that are malformed in the ways listed in Section 3.4 get a JSON-RPC error instead.

nouez → Claude Code: success

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 14, "result": {"content": [{"type": "text",
  "text": "Reply from codex-nouez-4d9f17:\n\nTwo issues. 1) ..."}], "isError": false}}
```

nouez → Claude Code: tool error

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 15, "result": {"content": [{"type": "text",
  "text": "Codex app-server daemon is not reachable, and starting it did not help. Run `codex app-server daemon start` in a
     terminal to see why, or open a Codex session."}],
  "isError": true}}
```

3.3 Cancellation

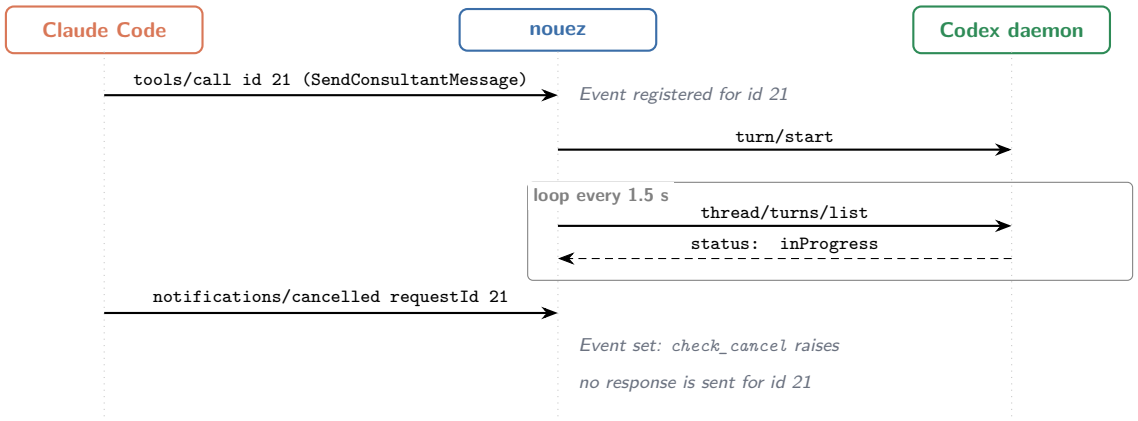


Figure 4: Cancelling a tool call. Cancelling stops nouez from waiting; it does not stop a Codex turn that has already started. Before delivery, the last `check_cancel` runs inside the send lock, so a cancel that arrives in time prevents the message from being sent at all.

Claude Code → nouez

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "method": "notifications/cancelled", "params": {"requestId": 21, "reason": "User interrupted"}}
```

3.4 Protocol errors

Each of these except `-32603` is covered by `tests/test_protocol.py`; the `-32603` message is an example, since nothing in the tests makes `dispatch()` fail. After every one of them the server keeps answering.

Line that isn't JSON: `{not json` → -32700

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": null, "error": {"code": -32700, "message": "Parse error"}}
```

Not an object (`[]`, `"hello"`), an id that isn't a string or number, or `"id": null` → -32600

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": null, "error": {"code": -32600, "message": "Invalid Request"}}
```

Unknown method → -32601

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 5, "error": {"code": -32601, "message": "Method not found: nope/nope"}}
```

`"params"` that isn't an object, `[]` included → -32602

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 2, "error": {"code": -32602, "message": "params must be an object."}}
```

`"arguments"` that isn't an object → -32602

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 3, "error": {"code": -32602, "message": "arguments must be an object."}}
```

"name": "Nope" → -32602

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 4, "error": {"code": -32602, "message": "Unknown tool: Nope"}}
```

Unexpected failure while handling a request → -32603

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 7, "error": {"code": -32603, "message": "Internal error: KeyError('id')"}}
```

Argument values are checked by the tool and reported as `isError` results:

Tool-level validation messages

```
‘to‘ is required: the consultant name StartConsultant returned, or its thread id.
‘message‘ is required.
‘new‘ must be true or false, not ’yes’.
‘wait‘ must be a number of seconds, 0 or more (0 = don’t wait), or "done", not -5.
‘until_done‘ was replaced by ‘wait‘ in nouez 0.4: pass wait="done".
‘timeout_seconds‘ was replaced by ‘wait‘ in nouez 0.4: pass wait=<seconds>.
codex-nouez-77c2e0 is a Codex session the user opened, not a read-only consultant: it keeps the user’s own permissions and may be
     able to edit files. Nothing was sent. Only if the user asked you to message this session, send again with allow_user_session
     =true; otherwise use StartConsultant.
```

All of these are checked before anything is sent; the last one after the session is found.

4 nouez ↔ Codex daemon

4.1 Connecting

A tool call that gets past argument checks opens a fresh `CodexClient` (WatchConsultant may open a second one) and closes it in a `finally` block, killing the proxy's process tree. The connection has four steps:

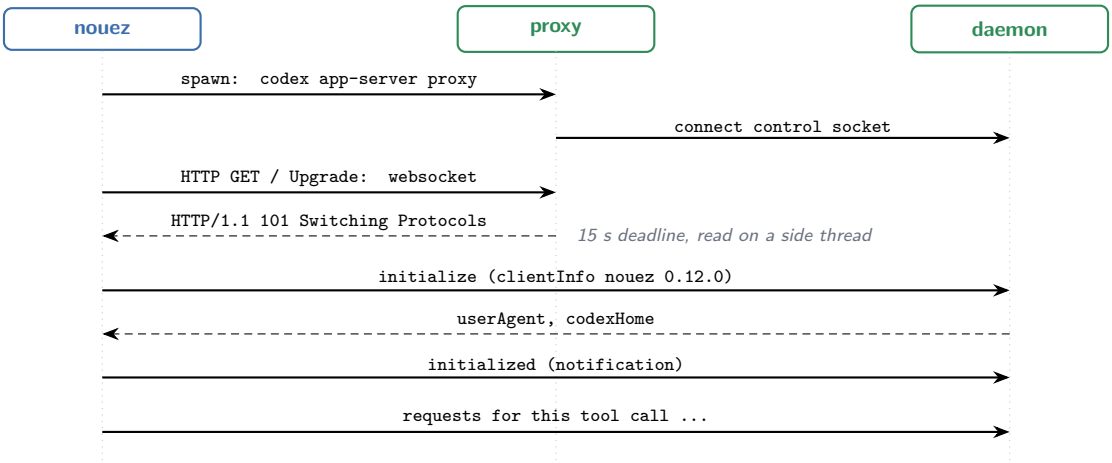


Figure 5: Opening a connection to the daemon. Bytes pass through the proxy unchanged.

nouez → proxy stdin: WebSocket upgrade

```
GET / HTTP/1.1
Host: localhost
Upgrade: websocket
Connection: Upgrade
Sec-WebSocket-Key: q3Xv0m5cJ0n9aB1kL2pR8w==
Sec-WebSocket-Version: 13
```

proxy stdout → nouez (only the status line is checked)

```
HTTP/1.1 101 Switching Protocols
Upgrade: websocket
Connection: Upgrade
Sec-WebSocket-Accept: ...
```

If the proxy closes its output before answering, no daemon is listening (it does not survive a restart of the computer). nouez then runs `codex app-server daemon start` once, without pipes and waiting at most 30 seconds for the command, and retries the connection every half second for up to 20 seconds. On Windows, when `MSYSTEM` says nouez runs under Git Bash (the waiter runs in Claude Code's Bash tool), the command gets the

environment without `MSYSTEM`, `SHELL` and `EXEPATH`, and without the `PATH` folders that hold `msys-2.0.dll`. The daemon and its updater inherit that environment, and the update script's bare `tar` would otherwise find GNU tar, which reads `C:` as a remote host. Only if that fails does it report *"Codex app-server daemon is not reachable, and starting it did not help. Run 'codex app-server daemon start' in a terminal to see why, or open a Codex session."* If the proxy says nothing within 15 seconds, *"Codex app-server proxy did not respond within 15s."*; for any status other than 101, *"WebSocket upgrade refused: <first 200 bytes of the header>"*.

4.2 Frames

Opcode	Meaning	nouez does
`0x1` text, `0x0` continuation	a JSON message, possibly split	reassemble until FIN, then parse
`0x9` ping	keep-alive from the daemon	answer with `0xA` pong, same payload
`0x8` close	daemon is closing	stop reading; pending requests fail

Frames nouez sends are masked, as RFC 6455 requires of clients: text frames for its messages and pong frames for the daemon's pings. A received message over 64 MiB ends the connection. A reader thread puts parsed messages on a queue; `request()` sends one message and waits up to 15 seconds for the response with the same `id`. Everything else the daemon sends meanwhile, notifications and the daemon's own requests alike, is discarded. A consultant never waits on those requests, because it was started with `approvalPolicy: "never"`.

4.3 Message format

The daemon speaks JSON-RPC without the `"jsonrpc"` member. Ids are integers counting from 1 on each connection.

nouez → daemon

```
{"id": 1, "method": "initialize", "params": {"clientInfo": {"name": "nouez", "version": "0.12.0"}}}
```

daemon → nouez

```
{"id": 1, "result": {
  "userAgent": "codex-tui/0.162.0 (Windows 10.0.26200; x86_64) WindowsTerminal (nouez; 0.12.0)",
  "codexHome": "C:\\Users\\you\\.codex",
  "platformFamily": "windows", "platformOs": "windows"}}
```

nouez → daemon

```
{"method": "initialized"}
```

daemon → nouez: an error response

```
{"id": 7, "error": {"code": -32600, "message": "thread 01a1f3c2-... is not materialized yet"}}
```

nouez turns an error response into *"<method> failed: <message>"*. A few messages mean "this session has no history yet" and are treated as an empty turn list rather than a failure: `not materialized`, `missing source rollout`, `no rollout found`, `is empty`, `list_turns is not supported yet`.

4.4 Data shapes

A thread (session), fields nouez reads; the daemon sends about 30

```
{"id": "01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17",
 "cwd": "C:\\Users\\you\\Projects\\nouez",
 "model": "gpt-5.6-sol", "modelProvider": "openai",
 "status": {"type": "idle"},            // "idle" | "active" (+ "activeFlags") | "notLoaded" | "systemError"
 "threadSource": "nouez",               // null for sessions the user opened
 "ephemeral": false, "parentThreadId": null,
 "name": "Diff review", "updatedAt": 1791547200}
```

The consultant's name is derived, not stored: `codex-` + the last folder of `cwd` + `-` + the last six characters of the id, lower-cased: `codex-nouez-4d9f17`.

A turn, fields nouez reads

```
{"id": "01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31",
 "status": "completed",                  // "inProgress" | "completed" | "interrupted" | "failed"
 "error": null,                          // may be {"message": "..."} when failed or interrupted
 "items": [
   {"type": "userMessage", "content": [{"type": "text",
     "text": "[Message from Claude Code via the consultants bridge]\n\nReview this diff ..."}]},
   {"type": "agentMessage", "phase": "commentary", "text": "Reading server.py ..."},
   {"type": "agentMessage", "phase": "final_answer", "text": "Two issues. 1) ..."}]}
```

`phase` is `"commentary"` for progress messages, `"final_answer"` for the answer, or `null`. For a turn that has ended, the reply is the text of all `agentMessage` items with `phase: "final_answer"`, or, if there are none, of the last `agentMessage`. For a turn still running, nouez shows the *output so far* instead: every `agentMessage` after the turn's latest `userMessage`, whatever its phase, keeping the last 4,000 characters. A steered message adds a `userMessage` to the running turn, so output written before it arrived is not shown as if it answered it. This is the snapshot from the latest poll; nouez polls instead of following streamed events, so it may lag the session by one poll.

4.5 Request reference

Method	Params nouez sends	Result nouez reads	Used by
`initialize`	`clientInfo`	`userAgent`, `codexHome`	every connection
`thread/loaded/list`	`{}` or `{cursor}`	`data`: ids, `nextCursor`	finding sessions
`thread/read`	`threadId`	`thread`	finding sessions
`thread/list`	`limit: 50`	`data`: summaries	finding unloaded consultants
`thread/start`	`cwd`, `sandbox`, `approvalPolicy`, `threadSource`, opt. `model`, `developerInstructions`	`thread`	StartConsultant
`thread/name/set`	`threadId`, `name`	–	StartConsultant `title`
`thread/resume`	`threadId`, `excludeTurns: true`	–	SendConsultantMessage
`thread/turns/list`*	`threadId`, `limit`, `sortDirection: "desc"`	`data`: turns, with items	send, wait, reply, watch
`turn/start`	`threadId`, `input`, `sandboxPolicy`, `approvalPolicy`†, opt. `model`, `effort`	`turn.id`	send to an idle session
`turn/steer`	`threadId`, `expectedTurnId`, `input`	`turnId` (not read)	send to a busy session
`thread/archive`	`threadId`	–	StopConsultant

*Codex marks `thread/turns/list` as experimental. nouez sends no `itemsView`; the daemons it was tested with returned each turn's items, but that default is not documented. †Sent only to nouez's own consultants: a read-only sandbox and `approvalPolicy: never`, on every turn, because Codex keeps them for later turns and permissions changed in a watch pane would otherwise carry over.

4.6 Finding a session

A `to` that is a full thread id is read directly with one `thread/read`, plus `thread/loaded/list` to know whether it is loaded. Every other `to` first lists sessions, then matches. Listing costs one request per session, because `thread/list` omits `threadSource`:

1. Sessions loaded in the daemon (paged)

```
-> {"id": 2, "method": "thread/loaded/list", "params": {}}
<- {"id": 2, "result": {"data": ["01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17", "01a1e8a0-..."], "nextCursor": null}}
```

2. Read each loaded session

```
-> {"id": 3, "method": "thread/read", "params": {"threadId": "01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17"}}
<- {"id": 3, "result": {"thread": {"id": "01a1f3c2-...", "cwd": "C:\\Users\\you\\Projects\\nouez", "threadSource": "nouez", "
     status": {"type": "idle"}, ...}}}
```

3. One page of up to 50 saved sessions, to find consultants the daemon has unloaded

```
-> {"id": 5, "method": "thread/list", "params": {"limit": 50}}
<- {"id": 5, "result": {"data": [{"id": "01a1d9b7-...", "status": {"type": "notLoaded"}, ...}, ...], "nextCursor": "..."}}
-> {"id": 6, "method": "thread/read", "params": {"threadId": "01a1d9b7-..."}}     // kept only if threadSource == "nouez"
```

Only that one page is read, so a consultant unloaded and older than the 50 sessions it holds is not listed. Then `to` is matched, case-insensitively: an exact name or id first; otherwise a unique id prefix or suffix (except for `StopConsultant`, which accepts only exact matches); otherwise a direct `thread/read` of `to` as a full id, which reaches older consultants. A name keeps only the id's last six characters, so two sessions can share one; such a name is refused, and the full id has to be used.

Matching failures (isError results)

```
'codex-nouez-4d9f17' names more than one session. Use the full thread id: 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17, 01a20b55-0c9e-7a13
     -b6f1-77e0aa4d9f17
'01a1' is ambiguous. Matches: codex-nouez-4d9f17, codex-nouez-77c2e0
No Codex session named 'codex-nouez-4d9f1'. Sessions: codex-nouez-4d9f17, codex-api-0b13aa
No Codex session named '4d9f17'. Use its exact name or full thread id. Sessions: codex-nouez-4d9f17
```

5 Tools, end to end

Each diagram starts with a `tools/call` and ends with its result. "Connect" stands for the handshake in Section 4, and "find session" for the lookup in Section 4.6. The example consultant is `codex-nouez-4d9f17`.

5.1 StartConsultant

Gets the consultant for a project. It reuses the most recently updated session that nouez started in the project's git repository (outside git, in the Claude Code workspace folder that contains `cwd`), and starts a new read-only one if there is none, or if `new: true`. It never reuses a session the user opened, because such a session keeps the user's sandbox and approval policy; those are only listed in the result.

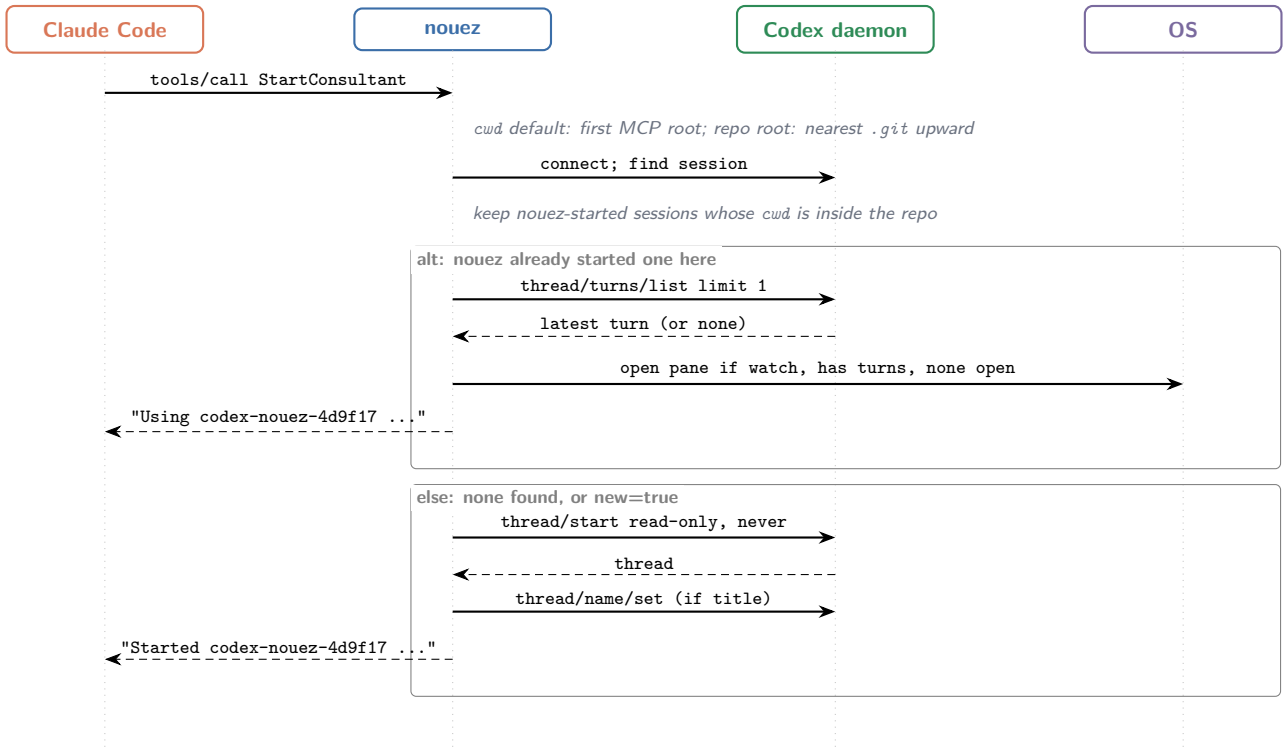


Figure 6: StartConsultant. A new session's pane opens with its first message, because `codex resume` can't show a session that has no turns yet.

Request

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 10, "method": "tools/call", "params": {"name": "StartConsultant",
  "arguments": {"cwd": "C:\\Users\\you\\Projects\\nouez", "title": "Diff review",
                "instructions": "You are a skeptical senior reviewer. Look for bugs; don't rewrite code."}}}
```

nouez → daemon when none exists

```
{"id": 8, "method": "thread/start", "params": {
  "cwd": "C:\\Users\\you\\Projects\\nouez", "sandbox": "read-only", "approvalPolicy": "never",
  "threadSource": "nouez",
  "developerInstructions": "Answer with a verdict line first, then findings, then what you didn't check."}}
{"id": 9, "method": "thread/name/set", "params": {"threadId": "01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17", "name": "Diff review"}}
```

Result text: started

```
Started codex-nouez-4d9f17
    id: 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17
    cwd: C:\Users\you\Projects\nouez
    model: gpt-5.6-sol (openai)
    sandbox: read-only
A pane showing it opens beside Claude Code when you send its first message.
Send it work with SendConsultantMessage.
```

Result text: reused

```
Using codex-nouez-4d9f17, which already works in C:\Users\you\Projects\nouez; nothing new was started.
- codex-nouez-4d9f17
    id: 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17
    cwd: C:\Users\you\Projects\nouez
    model: gpt-5.6-sol (openai), effort high
    status: idle (unloaded; reloads on the next message)
    started by: StartConsultant
    title: Diff review
    started: 2026-11-10 09:14 (2 days ago); 14 turn(s)
    last turn: 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31 [completed, 2026-11-12 16:40 (35 min ago), took 212s] from Claude Code: "
      Review this diff for bugs:" -> "Two issues. 1) route() accepts float ids but ..."
    GetConsultantHistory lists its earlier turns.
Opened codex-nouez-4d9f17 in a Windows Terminal split pane.
Ignored title, instructions: they apply only to a new session (new=true).
To give this consultant new standing instructions and keep its context, send them as a message with SendConsultantMessage.
Send it work with SendConsultantMessage.
The user's own Codex sessions in this repo were not used (they keep the user's permissions). Message one only if the user asks you
      to, with allow_user_session=true:
- codex-nouez-77c2e0
    id: 01a1e8a0-1c3d-7f02-8e44-90b1d577c2e0
    ...
    started by: user
Only if the user asks for a separate consultant, call StartConsultant with new=true.
```

The `started` and `last turn` lines come from `thread/turns/list` (up to 100 turns, newest first; "100+" when there may be more), and show when the session was created, how many turns it has had, and its last turn the way `GetConsultantHistory` does (Section 5.5), so Claude can tell whether it is still the right consultant. The effort is the one `thread/resume` reports. The pane line is omitted with `watch: false`. If the session has no turns yet it reads *"A pane showing it opens beside Claude Code when you send its first message."*, and if a terminal already shows it, nothing is opened and the line is *"... is already open in a terminal; no new one was opened."* The `watch` value of the latest StartConsultant call also decides whether later sends open a pane. The "Ignored" line appears only when `model`, `title` or `instructions` were passed, and the line after it only when `instructions` were. Other nouez sessions in the same repository follow *"Other consultants in this repo:"*, and the user-session note appears only when there are user sessions; it is added to the "Started" result too.

Both results end with an update notice when the `codex` CLI on the PATH or the daemon is older than the latest Codex release. nouez takes the latest version from `<codexHome>/version.json`, the cache Codex keeps for its own update check, so this check makes no network request. The CLI version comes from `codex -version` and the daemon's from `userAgent`. The notice names only the part that is behind and appears once per server process. It doesn't appear when the cache is missing or the user dismissed that version in Codex. nouez updates nothing itself; Claude runs the commands if the user asks:

Result text: update notice

```
Codex 0.165.0 is out; the codex CLI on PATH is 0.163.0 and the app-server daemon is 0.162.1. Tell the user and go ahead with the
     consultation. Only if the user asks you to update, run these in a shell: ‘codex update‘ updates the CLI; ‘codex app-server
     daemon update‘ updates the daemon, which may interrupt running Codex work, consultants and the user’s own sessions included.
```

A notice that a newer nouez is out comes before the Codex one. When Claude Code sends `initialize`, nouez starts a background thread that looks up the latest release, so no tool call waits for it. The thread first reads `nouez/latest-release.json` in the user's cache folder (`%LOCALAPPDATA%` on Windows, `$XDG_CACHE_HOME` or `~/.cache` elsewhere). An answer less than a day old is used as it is, and so is a failed attempt less than an hour old, which gives no notice. Otherwise nouez asks GitHub, with no credentials and a 3-second timeout on each network step (not a deadline for the whole request: name lookup and several slow reads can take longer), and saves the result, a failure included, through a temporary file of its own (`mkstemp`) and `os.replace`, so servers starting together don't write into one file. Servers that start at the same moment may each ask. GitHub sees the request's IP address and time and the version in `User-Agent`; the request goes through any proxy set in the environment. A cache file over 4 KB, or one whose fields aren't a finite time and a version of at most six digits per part, is ignored. A thread that can't start, or any error in the check or the notice, leaves the `initialize` answer and the consultation as they are. Setting `NOUEZ_NO_UPDATE_CHECK=1` turns the lookup off.

nouez to GitHub (HTTPS)

```
GET https://api.github.com/repos/jibarix/nouez/releases/latest
Accept: application/vnd.github+json
User-Agent: nouez/0.12.0

200 {"tag_name": "v0.13.0", ...}            (drafts and pre-releases are never "latest")
```

nouez keeps the version only if the tag reads v*n.n.n*; anything else, and any failure (offline, a proxy, a rate limit), means no notice. The notice appears once per server process, only for a version newer than the running one. The command it gives uses the folder `server.py` runs from, in single quotes, which PowerShell and POSIX shells read literally, so a folder name like `$(...)` can't run anything. A folder whose name has a `'` or a control character gets no command: Claude is told to ask the user to run the pull. If the folder isn't a git checkout, the notice points to the release page instead. Either way, Claude asks the user to reconnect only after the update worked:

Result text: nouez update notice

```
nouez 0.13.0 is out; this server is 0.12.0. What changed: https://github.com/jibarix/nouez/releases/tag/v0.13.0. Tell the user and
     go ahead with the consultation. Only if the user asks you to update, run ‘git -C ’C:/Users/you/nouez’ pull --ff-only‘ in a
     shell. If git fails (local changes, a conflict, no branch checked out), stop there: tell the user what git said, don’t ask
     them to reconnect, and don’t discard, stash or switch anything without the user’s say. Only after the pull succeeds, ask the
     user to run /mcp and reconnect consultants, which loads the new version; the Codex consultants keep their sessions.
```

5.2 ListConsultants

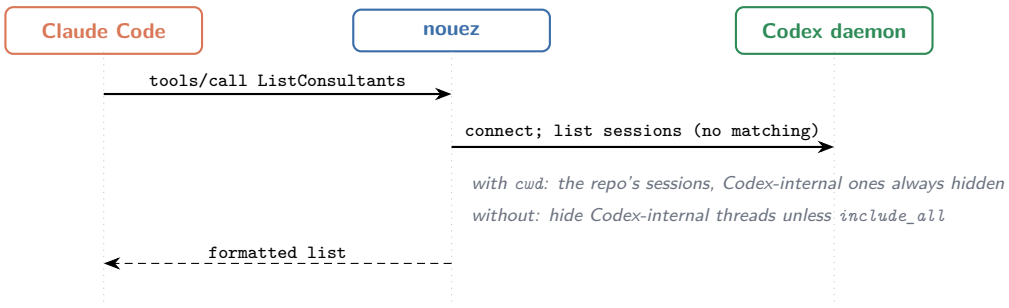


Figure 7: ListConsultants. Read-only; makes no changes. It lists the user's sessions too.

Request

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 11, "method": "tools/call", "params": {"name": "ListConsultants",
  "arguments": {"cwd": "C:\\Users\\you\\Projects\\nouez"}}}
```

Result text

```
2 Codex session(s) in C:\Users\you\Projects\nouez:
- codex-nouez-4d9f17
    id: 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17
    cwd: C:\Users\you\Projects\nouez
    model: gpt-5.6-sol (openai)
    status: busy
    started by: StartConsultant
- codex-nouez-77c2e0
    id: 01a1e8a0-1c3d-7f02-8e44-90b1d577c2e0
    cwd: C:\Users\you\Projects\nouez
    model: gpt-6-astra (openai)
    status: idle
    started by: user
```

Result text: nothing found

```
No Codex sessions in C:\Users\you\Projects\nouez. Start one with StartConsultant, or open Codex in a terminal.
```

5.3 SendConsultantMessage

The central tool. A lock per session, held only inside this nouez process, makes sure two of its concurrent sends can't both start a turn; it does not cover other clients of the daemon, such as the user typing in a Codex terminal. The lock is held through delivery, the check that the new turn is listed, and opening the pane, and is released before the long wait, so a slow reply doesn't block other senders.

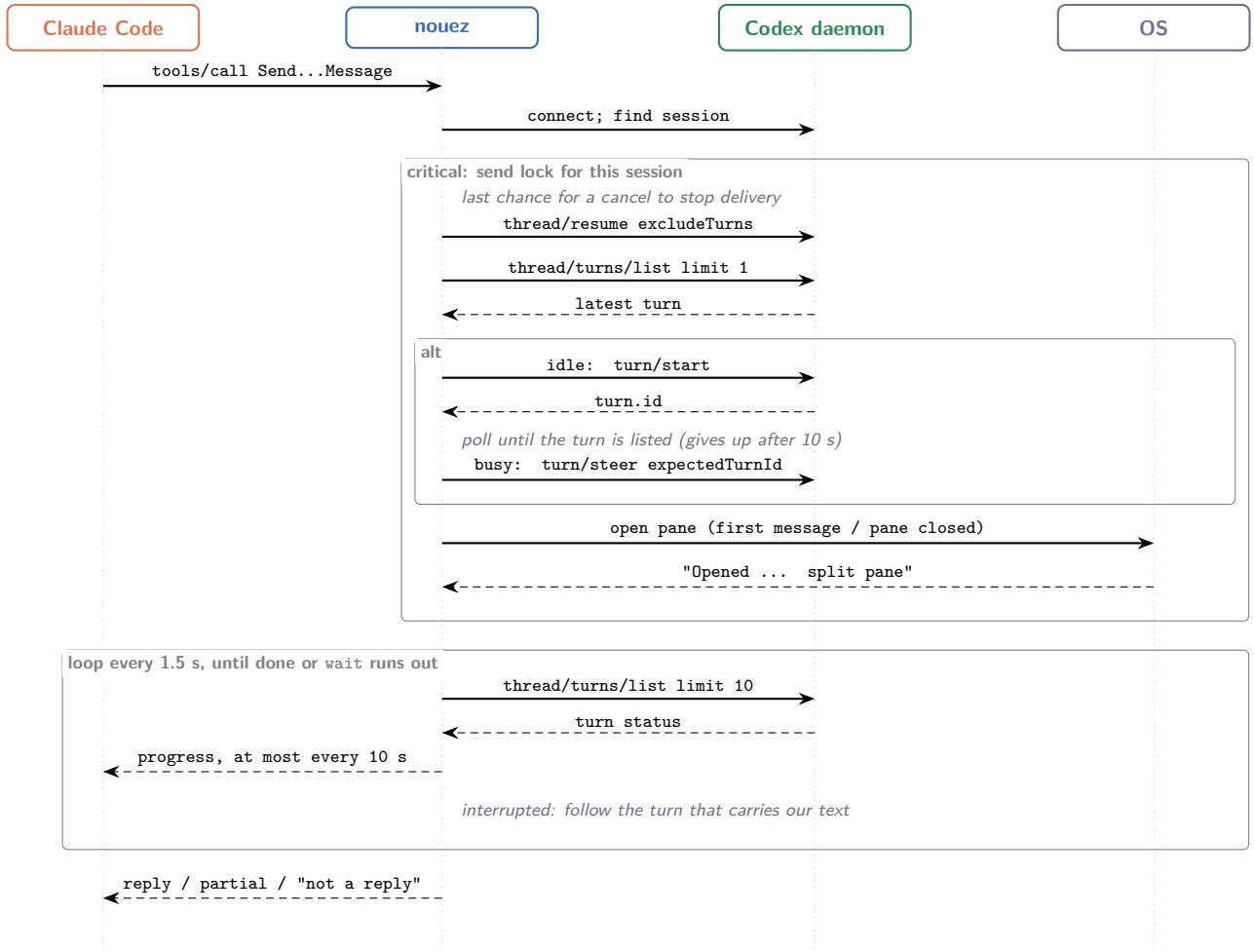


Figure 8: SendConsultantMessage with a `wait` above zero (the default is 5 seconds). Before the lock, a session the user opened is refused unless `allow_user_session: true`, and nothing is sent. Progress notifications go out only if the request carried a progress token. With `wait: 0` it returns after the steps inside the lock (delivery, the listing check and the pane), skipping only the wait for the reply. The 10 s check stops polling after 10 s, but a slow `thread/turns/list` request can take up to its own 15 s timeout, so it is not a hard bound.

Request

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 14, "method": "tools/call", "params": {"name": "SendConsultantMessage",
  "arguments": {"to": "codex-nouez-4d9f17", "message": "Review this diff for bugs:\n\n```diff\n...\n```",
                "from": "Claude Code (nouez)", "wait": 600}}}
```

Every message reaches Codex with a header naming the sender:

nouez → daemon: session idle

```
{"id": 4, "method": "thread/resume", "params": {"threadId": "01a1f3c2-...", "excludeTurns": true}}
{"id": 5, "method": "thread/turns/list", "params": {"threadId": "01a1f3c2-...", "limit": 1, "sortDirection": "desc"}}
{"id": 6, "method": "turn/start", "params": {"threadId": "01a1f3c2-...", "input": [{"type": "text",
  "text": "[Message from Claude Code (nouez) via the consultants bridge]\n\nReview this diff for bugs: ..."}]}}
```

daemon → nouez

```
{"id": 6, "result": {"turn": {"id": "01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31", ...}}}
```

Two options add to the text, and only when passed. `owner_words` is the user's own words, quoted as they typed them; they go first, marked off, and the rest is labelled as the sender's, so the consultant can tell the request from Claude's reading of it. `revision: true` adds a line after the header with the git commit, branch and number of uncommitted paths in the consultant's folder (from `git rev-parse` and `git status -porcelain`, run by nouez with a timeout) and asks the consultant to name that revision in its answer. Outside git the line says so.

turn/start text with `"from": "lead"`, `owner_words` and `"revision": true`

```
"[Message from lead via the consultants bridge]\n[Revision: commit 35729af on main, 2 uncommitted path(s). Name this revision in
     your answer.]\n
The user's own words, as they typed them:\n<<<\nmake sure the new flag can't break old callers\n>>>\n\n
The rest of this message is lead's.\n\nReview this diff for bugs: ..."
```

`model` and `effort` change the consultant's Codex model or reasoning effort without starting a new session, so it keeps its context. nouez refuses only an empty value, blanks and control characters (provider ids such as `gpt-oss:20b` pass) and leaves Codex to reject one the model doesn't support. They go into `turn/start`, and Codex keeps them for the session's later turns as well, so the result says the setting stays until changed, after a quick reply too. A running turn can't change them: when nouez sees the session busy, a send with either is refused and nothing is sent, rather than steering the turn with them silently dropped. Like the choice between start and steer, this check is not atomic: a turn another client starts between it and `turn/start` is not seen.

nouez → daemon: session idle, sent with `"effort": "xhigh"`

```
{"id": 6, "method": "turn/start", "params": {"threadId": "01a1f3c2-...", "input": [...], "effort": "xhigh"}}
```

Result text: refused, session busy

```
codex-nouez-4d9f17 is still working on turn 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31, and a running turn can't change its effort.
     Nothing was sent. Read that turn's reply with GetConsultantReply first, then send again; or send now without effort to add
     the message to the running turn.
```

nouez → daemon: session busy, so the message steers the running turn

```
{"id": 6, "method": "turn/steer", "params": {"threadId": "01a1f3c2-...",
  "expectedTurnId": "01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31",
  "input": [{"type": "text", "text": "[Message from Claude Code via the consultants bridge]\n\nAlso check the tests."}]}}
```

Waiting: polled every 1.5 s

```
-> {"id": 9, "method": "thread/turns/list", "params": {"threadId": "01a1f3c2-...", "limit": 10, "sortDirection": "desc"}}
<- {"id": 9, "result": {"data": [{"id": "01a1f3c4-...", "status": "inProgress", "items": [...]}, ...]}}
   ...
<- {"id": 61, "result": {"data": [{"id": "01a1f3c4-...", "status": "completed", "items": [...]}, ...]}}
```

Result text: completed

```
Reply from codex-nouez-4d9f17:

Two issues. 1) route() accepts float ids but ...

(codex-nouez-4d9f17 runs on model gpt-5.6-sol, effort high.)

(Opened codex-nouez-4d9f17 in a Windows Terminal split pane.)
```

When the send didn't change `model` or `effort`, the result says what the consultant runs on: in a line after a reply, and in the "started a new turn" text. When it did, it says the new setting stays until changed instead.

Result text: wait=0

```
Delivered to codex-nouez-4d9f17 (started a new turn on model gpt-5.6-sol, effort high, turn 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31).
      Don't wait for the reply. To be woken when it is ready, run this as a background command (in Claude Code: the Bash or
      PowerShell tool with run_in_background); it exits with the reply when the turn ends:
C:/Python313/python.exe -I C:/Users/you/nouez/server.py wait 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6
      a9c0f2e7d31
Then tell the user the consultation is under way and carry on with other work or end your turn. If you can't run background
      commands, read the reply later with GetConsultantReply (turn_id 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31).
```

Result text: timeout (isError false; the message was delivered)

```
codex-nouez-4d9f17 is still working on turn 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31; this is not a reply. Delivered (started a new
      turn), but no reply within 600s. Don't send the message again. Don't wait for the reply. To be woken when it is ready, run
      this as a background command (in Claude Code: the Bash or PowerShell tool with run_in_background); it exits with the reply
      when the turn ends:
C:/Python313/python.exe -I C:/Users/you/nouez/server.py wait 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6
      a9c0f2e7d31
Then tell the user the consultation is under way and carry on with other work or end your turn. If you can't run background
      commands, read the reply later with GetConsultantReply (turn_id 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31).

Output so far (a snapshot of the running turn; it may change and is not the final answer):
Reading server.py ... route() looks fine; checking dispatch next.
```

The "Output so far" block is left out when the turn has written nothing since the message arrived. If an interrupted turn carried on in a new one, the turn id given is the new one's.

Result text: waiting failed after delivery (isError true)

```
Delivered to codex-nouez-4d9f17 (started a new turn, turn 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31), but waiting for the reply failed:
      thread/turns/list timed out after 15s. Don't send the message again; read the reply with GetConsultantReply (turn_id 01
      a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31).
```

Result text: the turn ended without completing

```
codex-nouez-4d9f17: turn 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31 interrupted.
Partial reply:
Reading server.py ...
If the message was folded into a later turn, read it with GetConsultantReply.
```

Result text: the turn failed inside Codex

```
codex-nouez-4d9f17: turn 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31 failed. stream disconnected before completion
Partial reply:
(none)
The turn failed inside Codex (the error above is Codex's), not in nouez, and the message got no answer. Sending the message again
      is safe: the consultant keeps its context, so say briefly that the last turn failed and ask again. If it fails the same way
      twice, start a new consultant (StartConsultant with new=true) and give it a short summary of what it needs.
```

Result text: reply over 60,000 characters

```
Reply from codex-nouez-4d9f17:

<first 60,000 characters>

[Truncated: 18422 more characters. The full reply is saved in C:\Users\you\AppData\Local\Temp\nouez\01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6
    a9c0f2e7d31.md. Or read the rest with GetConsultantReply (turn_id 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31, offset 60000).]
```

5.4 GetConsultantReply

Reads a reply without sending anything. A send returns after 5 seconds by default, usually before the reply is ready, and Claude is told not to wait for it but to run the waiter (next section) in the background. Without background commands, it calls this tool with the returned `turn_id` when the user asks or when it next needs the reply, and the call returns at once. When the user does want Claude to wait, it passes `wait: "done"`. That call returns when the turn ends, when an error occurs (such as a lost daemon connection), or after the 4-hour cap, so a client that moved it to the background is notified when the reply is ready, up to one 1.5-second poll late. An error or the cap is not a reply; call again.

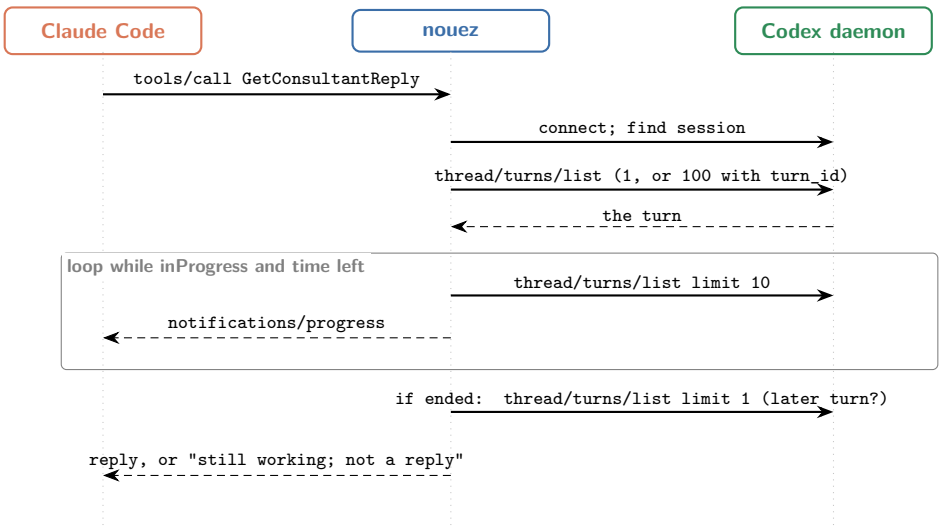


Figure 9: GetConsultantReply. `wait` defaults to 0: return at once. It reads user sessions too; only sending is guarded.

Request

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 16, "method": "tools/call", "params": {"name": "GetConsultantReply",
  "arguments": {"to": "codex-nouez-4d9f17", "turn_id": "01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31", "wait": "done"}}}
```

Result text: variants

```
Reply from codex-nouez-4d9f17:

Two issues. 1) ...

codex-nouez-4d9f17 is still working on turn 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31; this is not a reply. To be woken when it is
    ready, run in the background:
C:/Python313/python.exe -I C:/Users/you/nouez/server.py wait 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6
    a9c0f2e7d31
Or check again later with turn_id 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31; pass wait="done" only if the user wants you to wait for it
    .

Output so far (a snapshot of the running turn; it may change and is not the final answer):
Reading server.py ...

codex-nouez-4d9f17 has no messages yet.

codex-nouez-4d9f17 has no turn 01a1ffff-... among its 100 most recent turns.
```

An interrupted turn followed by a newer turn adds: *"A later turn exists (01a1f3c6-..., completed). If your message continued there, read it by omitting turn_id."* nouez does not check that the later turn holds the message here; the newer turn may be someone else's.

`offset`, a whole number of characters, reads a finished reply from that point, up to 60,000 characters at a time,

and names the offset to read on from. It is how Claude reads the rest of a cut reply without opening the saved file. An offset past the end says so; on a running turn it is ignored and the usual "still working" result comes back.

Result text: with `"offset": 60000`

```
Reply from codex-nouez-4d9f17 (turn 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31, completed), characters 60000-78422 of 78422:

<the rest of the reply>
```

5.5 GetConsultantHistory

Lists a consultant's recent turns, newest first, one line each, from one `thread/turns/list` (`limit`, default 20, at most 100). Each line gives the turn id, status, when it started and how long it took, the sender (the `from` label in a bridge message's header, or "someone in the Codex pane" for text typed there), the first line of the message and of the reply, and how many messages steered the turn while it ran. For a bridge message the revision line and the `owner_words` framing are skipped, so the line shows the sender's own text. It reads only, user sessions included.

Result text

```
codex-nouez-4d9f17 (started 2026-11-10 09:14 (2 days ago)): its 2 most recent turn(s), newest first. Read a whole reply with
     GetConsultantReply and the turn id.
- 01a1f3c4-8b20-7d55-b1e3-6a9c0f2e7d31 [completed, 2026-11-12 16:40 (35 min ago), took 212s] from Claude Code: "Review this diff
     for bugs:" (+1 more message(s) added while it ran) -> "Two issues. 1) route() accepts float ids but ..."
- 01a1e902-77aa-7c10-9e2d-41b0c3d8a6f0 [completed, 2026-11-10 09:15 (2 days ago), took 48s] from someone in the Codex pane: "what
     does resolve() do?" -> "It lists sessions, then matches ..."
```

5.6 The waiter command

`server.py wait <thread_id> <turn_id>` is not a tool but a command line. A send that returns before the reply, and a `GetConsultantReply` that finds the turn still working, give it with full paths (`sys.executable -I` and the absolute path of `server.py`) and tell Claude to run it as a background command. In Claude Code that is the Bash or PowerShell tool with `run_in_background`: Claude is free at once, and when the command exits Claude Code wakes it with the command's output, so the reply arrives without the user asking for it. A path is quoted only if it contains a space (the command then adds that PowerShell needs `&` before it), so the command runs as is in either shell and a permission rule can match it by prefix.

`server.py allow-rule` prints those rules for the interpreter that runs it, one per shell tool:

```
Add these to permissions.allow in ~/.claude/settings.json:
"Bash(C:/Python313/python.exe -I C:/Users/you/nouez/server.py wait *)",
"PowerShell(C:/Python313/python.exe -I C:/Users/you/nouez/server.py wait *)"
```

They name one interpreter and one script, so Claude Code keeps them in auto mode, which drops only broad interpreter rules; without them it asks before each waiter, or auto mode may block it.

The waiter opens its own connection, resolves the thread by exact id, and looks for the turn among its `REPLY_LOOKBACK` (100) most recent turns. A turn that is missing ends it with exit code 1. A turn that has already ended is printed at once; a running one, which is always among the newest, is polled with `wait_for_turn` for up to `WAITER_SECONDS` (25 minutes). Claude Code stops a background command after 30 minutes by default, so at that point the waiter exits with code 0 and the *still working* result, including the output so far and the same command to run again; Claude starts a new waiter. When the turn ends, the waiter prints *"The consultant's turn has ended (thread . . . , turn . . .)."* and the turn formatted as `GetConsultantReply` would, with the reply cut at `WAITER_REPLY_CHARS` (20,000) characters and the rest saved to a file, and exits with code 0. Its standard output is UTF-8.

A failed connection (`BridgeError`, or an `OSError` such as a broken pipe) is retried 10 seconds later, never past the 25-minute deadline. After `WAITER_RETRIES` (3) failures in a row, a count that each working connection resets, it prints *"Stopped waiting for turn . . . "* with a pointer to `GetConsultantReply` and exits with code 1. The waiter dies with the Claude Code session that started it; the reply stays readable with `GetConsultantReply`.

5.7 The doctor command

`server.py doctor` is a command line too, for checking a setup. It prints one line per check, marked `[ok]`, `[note]` or `[problem]`: nouez's version and path and the Python running it; the `codex` CLI on the PATH; whether the app-server daemon answers, with its version and any update notice (connecting may start it, as any consultation would); whether `settings.json` in Claude Code's config folder holds the waiter's allow rules; and, on Windows, whether Windows Terminal and `claude` are on the PATH. It changes nothing, and exits with code 1 when a problem blocks consultations.

Output

```
[ok] nouez 0.12.0 at C:\Users\you\nouez\server.py, Python 3.13.5 at C:\Python313\python.exe
[ok] codex CLI 0.165.0 at C:\Users\you\AppData\Roaming\npm\codex.CMD
[ok] the Codex app-server daemon answers (version 0.167.2)
[ok] Claude Code allows the waiter command without asking
[ok] Windows Terminal is installed: panes open beside Claude Code
[ok] claude at C:\Users\you\.local\bin\claude.exe (for OpenClaudeSession)
No problems found.
```

5.8 WatchConsultant

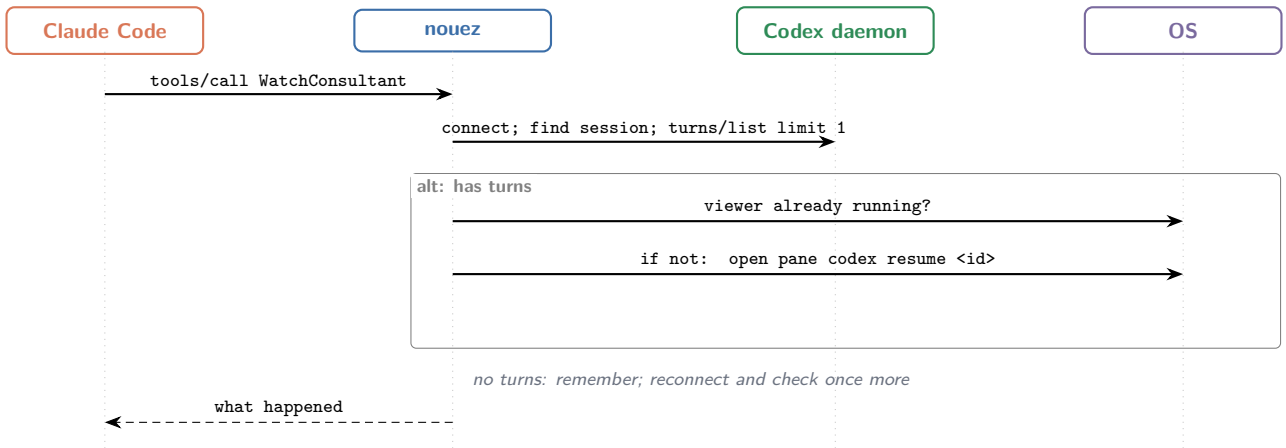


Figure 10: WatchConsultant. With no turns, it records the request and opens a second connection to check again, in case a send slipped in; otherwise the next SendConsultantMessage opens the pane. It works on the user's sessions too.

Request

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 17, "method": "tools/call", "params": {"name": "WatchConsultant", "arguments": {"to": "codex-nouez-4d9f17
    "}}}
```

Result text: variants

```
Opened codex-nouez-4d9f17 in a Windows Terminal split pane.
codex-nouez-4d9f17 is already open in a terminal; no new one was opened.
codex-nouez-4d9f17 has no messages yet; a terminal window will open when you send the first one.
Opened codex-nouez-4d9f17 in Windows Terminal. Warning: the codex CLI on PATH is 0.160.1 but the daemon is 0.162.0, so the window
    may ask to restart the daemon. Choose Cancel (restarting interrupts running consultants) and update the codex CLI to 0.162.0.
```

5.9 StopConsultant

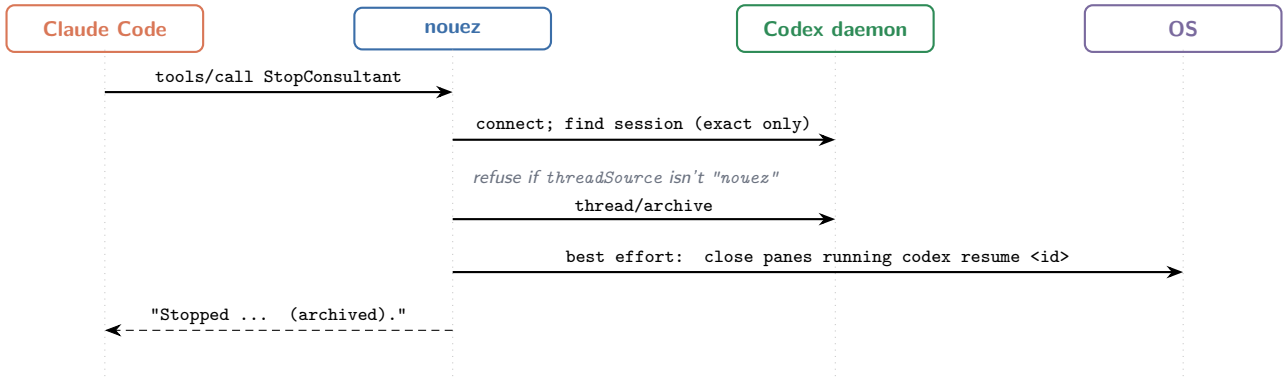


Figure 11: StopConsultant. Archiving is reversible: `codex unarchive <id>`. Panes are found by command line; the count in the result is how many matched, and a failed close is not reported.

Request

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 18, "method": "tools/call", "params": {"name": "StopConsultant", "arguments": {"to": "codex-nouez-4d9f17"
    }}}
```

nouez → daemon

```
{"id": 7, "method": "thread/archive", "params": {"threadId": "01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17"}}
```

Result text

```
Stopped codex-nouez-4d9f17 (archived). Closed 1 terminal window(s) showing it. To bring it back: codex unarchive 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7
    c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17, then codex resume 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17.
```

Result text: refused (isError true)

```
codex-nouez-77c2e0 was not started by StartConsultant. Close it from its own terminal.
```

5.10 Claude Code sessions

`OpenClaudeSession` takes `cwd` (required, an absolute path), `name` (default: the folder's name; letters, digits, spaces, `.`, `_` and `-`, starting with a letter or digit, up to 64 characters, so it can't be read as an option), an optional first `prompt`, `model` (default `opus`, the latest Opus), `effort` (default `medium`), `create`, `trust` and `open_untrusted`. The session starts with `-model` and `-effort` from those, not the user's own Claude Code defaults, and with `CLAUDE_CODE_EFFORT_LEVEL` set to the same effort, since that variable outranks the flag; a model must be an alias or a full model name, so it can't read as another option. With `create: true` a missing folder is made (its parent must exist). It writes `cwd`, name, prompt, model and effort to a temporary file and opens a new terminal window running `server.py claude <file>` (Section 6.3); the window reads the file, deletes it, and starts Claude Code.

First it checks whether Claude Code has been trusted in the folder (Section 6.3), since a session waiting at the trust question can't connect. If not, nothing opens and the result tells Claude to ask the user whether they trust

the folder. Only if they say yes does Claude call again with `trust: true`: nouez records the answer as the trust dialog would, after backing up Claude Code's state file (Section 6.3), and opens the window, so it works from the phone. `open_untrusted: true` opens the window untrusted instead, with a warning, for a user at the computer who would rather answer Claude Code's own question. If nouez can't tell, the window opens and the result says the session may be waiting at the question.

Claude Code → nouez

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 19, "method": "tools/call", "params": {"name": "OpenClaudeSession", "arguments": {"cwd": "C:\\Users\\me\\
    Projects\\other"}}}
```

Result text

```
Opened a new Windows Terminal window in C:\Users\me\Projects\other running Claude Code (opus, medium effort) with Remote Control,
    named "other". It is a normal session: its transcript is saved and it can be resumed later. It appears in the Claude app's
    session list under that name once it connects, in a few seconds. Checked: it is running and connected to Remote Control.
```

Before opening, nouez reads the session registry (Section 5.10); after opening a trusted folder, it reads it once a second for up to 15 seconds, looking for a new pid in that folder, and ends the result with what it found. The window opens either way, and a registry it can't read only leaves the note out. A session already running in the folder is named too.

Result text: other endings

```
... Note: another Claude Code session was already running in this folder: nouez-2a (pid 31940). Both can work there; they don't
    see each other's conversation. Checked: it is running and connected to Remote Control.
... Checked: it is running, but hadn't connected to Remote Control after 15s. It may still be connecting, or waiting for an answer
     on the computer.
... Checked: it hadn't shown up as a running session after 15s. It may still be starting, or waiting for an answer on the computer
    ; ListClaudeSessions shows it once it runs.
```

Claude Code → nouez: a new folder

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 20, "method": "tools/call", "params": {"name": "OpenClaudeSession", "arguments": {"cwd": "C:\\Users\\me\\
    Projects\\economic-recession", "create": true}}}
```

Result text: folder not trusted

```
Created the folder C:\Users\me\Projects\economic-recession. Not opened: Claude Code hasn't been trusted in C:\Users\me\Projects\
    economic-recession, so a session there would wait at the trust question on the computer and couldn't connect to the Claude
    app until someone answers it. Ask the user whether they trust this folder: trusting it lets its Claude Code settings, hooks
    and MCP servers run. Only if they say yes, call OpenClaudeSession again with trust=true, which records their answer in
    Claude Code's settings as the trust dialog would (backing the file up first). If they're at the computer and would rather
    answer Claude Code's own question there, use open_untrusted=true.
```

Claude Code → nouez: the user said they trust it

```
{"jsonrpc": "2.0", "id": 21, "method": "tools/call", "params": {"name": "OpenClaudeSession", "arguments": {"cwd": "C:\\Users\\me\\
    Projects\\economic-recession", "trust": true}}}
```

Result text: trust recorded

```
Recorded the user's trust in C:/Users/me/Projects/economic-recession in Claude Code's settings (C:\Users\me\.claude.json), as its
    trust dialog would. The file as it was is backed up in C:\Users\me\AppData\Local\nouez\claude-json-backups\.claude.json
    .20261107-190412.k3j2x9.bak. Opened a new Windows Terminal window in ...
```

A folder inside a trusted folder (outside git) counts as trusted, but Claude Code can still ask there: allow rules and additional directories in the project's `.claude/settings.json` need the folder itself trusted, and `.mcp.json` servers have their own approval. When those files are there, the result adds a note:

Result text: may still ask

```
Opened ... Note: the session may wait for an answer on the computer: its .mcp.json servers are approved separately, so Claude Code
     may ask before connecting them.
```

`ListClaudeSessions` takes no arguments. Each row gives the session's name, process id, folder and status, and notes Remote Control, sessions `OpenClaudeSession` opened, and the caller.

Result text

```
Claude Code sessions running on this computer:
- hours-tracker-74 (pid 38748): C:\Users\me\Projects\hours-tracker [idle, Remote Control]
- nouez-2a (pid 31940): C:\Users\me\Projects\nouez [busy, Remote Control, this session]
- other (pid 20964): C:\Users\me\Projects\other [idle, Remote Control, opened by OpenClaudeSession]
```

`CloseClaudeSession` takes `name`, or `pid` to pick one of several sessions with the same name, and closes one session per call. It refuses the caller, and the tool description tells Claude to close only sessions the user picked from the list.

Result text

```
Closed other (pid 20964) and its window. Its transcript is kept: ‘claude --resume 2e130d9e-3cce-4a4c-aed2-9693deab1875‘ in C:\
     Users\me\Projects\other picks it up again.
```

Result text: refused (isError true)

```
That is the session you are running in; it can’t close itself.
```

6 nouez → operating system

6.1 Opening a pane

The pane runs the daemon’s own `codex` binary when nouez can find it, because a viewer whose version differs from the daemon’s can refuse to attach and offer to restart the shared daemon. nouez reads the daemon’s version from `userAgent` and looks under `<codexHome>/packages/app-server-daemon/releases/<version>-*/bin/`, confirming with `codex -version`.

Where Claude Code runs	Command nouez starts
tmux (`$TMUX` set)	`tmux split-window -h -c <cwd> ’<codex> resume <id>’`
Windows Terminal (`$WT_SESSION`)	`wt -w 0 split-pane -V -d <cwd> -title "Codex consultant" cmd /k <codex> resume <id>`, with Claude Code’s window brought to the front first (below); new-tab instead of split-pane when Claude Code’s tab isn’t selected; `-w new` when the window can’t be found or brought to the front. In every argument after `-w`, `;` is passed as `\;` (wt splits commands at a bare one)
Windows, `wt` installed	`wt -w new -d <cwd> -title "Codex consultant" cmd /k <codex> resume <id>`
Windows, no `wt`	`cmd /c start "Codex consultant" cmd /k <codex> resume <id>`
macOS	`osascript -e ’tell application "Terminal" to do script "cd <cwd> && <codex> resume <id>"’ -e ’... activate’`
Linux	`x-terminal-emulator -e | gnome-terminal - | xterm -e <codex> resume <id>`

Finding Claude Code’s window (Windows Terminal)

`wt.exe` can name a window only by number or name, and `-w 0` means the most recently used window, which may belong to another Claude Code session. So nouez first finds the window that shows its own Claude Code session. Claude Code starts `server.py` without a console, so nouez borrows one: walking up its parent processes, it calls `AttachConsole` on each until one has a console, which is Claude Code’s. In Windows Terminal that console’s window (`GetConsoleWindow`) is a hidden pseudo-console window, owned by the terminal window it is shown in (`GetWindow(..., GW_OWNER)`, class `CASCADIA_HOSTING_WINDOW_CLASS`). `AttachConsole` and `FreeConsole` replace the standard handles, which carry the MCP pipes and are what `subprocess` hands to children, so nouez saves them first and restores them after each attempt. The lookup runs under a lock, as a process has only one console at a time.

nouez then brings that window to the front (`AttachThreadInput` to the foreground thread, `SetForegroundWindow`) and checks that it is in front. Attaching makes nouez wait on the foreground program, so it skips that step when `IsHungAppWindow` says the program isn’t responding. It compares the console’s title with the window’s, ignoring the spinner Claude Code animates at the start: the window shows the title of its selected tab, so a mismatch means another tab is selected, and `split-pane` would split that one. nouez runs `wt -w 0 split-pane ...` (or `new-tab ...`), waits for `wt.exe` to exit and another half second for the terminal to act on it, and gives the focus

back to the window that had it. If the window can't be found or brought to the front, the consultant gets a window of its own (`wt -w new`). Two gaps remain: another window that comes to the front between the check and `wt` gets the pane, and two tabs with the same title look alike.

6.2 Detecting and closing panes

Thread ids are checked against `[0-9A-Za-z-]+` before they appear in any command: opening a pane refuses a malformed id with an error, and the checks and closing skip it.

Is a viewer already running? (Windows)

```
powershell -NoProfile -NonInteractive -Command
  @(Get-CimInstance Win32_Process -Filter "Name='codex.exe'" |
    Where-Object { $_.CommandLine -like '* resume 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17*' }).Count
-> 1
```

Is a viewer already running? (macOS, Linux)

```
pgrep -f "codex[^ ]* resume 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17"
```

Closing on StopConsultant (Windows), abridged: find the cmd windows nouez opened, with their children

```
powershell ... Get-CimInstance Win32_Process -Filter "Name='cmd.exe'" |
  Where-Object { $_.CommandLine -like '*/k *codex* resume 01a1f3c2-...' } | ForEach-Object { "$p $k" }
-> 18244 20112
taskkill /PID 20112 /T /F            (codex inside the pane)
TerminateProcess(18244, exit code 0) (cmd; a clean exit lets Windows Terminal close the pane)
```

Closing on StopConsultant (macOS, Linux)

```
pkill -f "codex[^ ]* resume 01a1f3c2-5e7b-7c41-9a0d-2b6e8c4d9f17"
```

The last two lines are what nouez does, not commands it runs: `taskkill` is run per child, and the cmd process is ended through the Win32 `TerminateProcess` call.

Each check and close command has a timeout (20 s; 10 s for `codex -version`). When it fires, nouez stops reading the command's pipes, because on Windows a grandchild process can keep a pipe open forever, and kills the process: the whole tree on Windows (`taskkill /T`), only the direct process elsewhere. A pane started with `tmux`, a new terminal window or `wt -w new` is started without waiting, so it has no timeout. In Claude Code's own Windows Terminal window, nouez waits for `wt.exe` to exit (up to 10 s) and then half a second more, besides finding the window and bringing it to the front (Section 6.1), so that call can take that long.

6.3 Starting and ending Claude Code sessions

`OpenClaudeSession` opens a new window: in Windows Terminal with the command below, otherwise in a new console (Windows), Terminal (macOS) or the first of `x-terminal-emulator`, `gnome-terminal` and `xterm` (Linux).

The window's command

```
wt -w new -d <cwd> --title "Claude: <name>"
  <python> -I <path>/server.py claude <temp>/nouez-claude-<random>.json
```

That helper reads and deletes the file, then starts Claude Code in `cwd`:

What the helper runs

```
claude --remote-control <name> --name <name> --model <model> --effort <effort> [-- <prompt>]
```

Claude Code sets `CLAUDECODE`, `CLAUDE_CODE_CHILD_SESSION`, `CLAUDE_CODE_SESSION_ID` and similar variables for every command it runs, and a `claude` that inherits `CLAUDE_CODE_CHILD_SESSION` doesn't save its transcript. So the helper starts `claude` without `CLAUDECODE`, `CLAUDE_PID`, `CLAUDE_EFFORT`, `AI_AGENT` and the `CLAUDE_CODE_*` variables Claude Code sets for its commands (`CHILD_SESSION`, `SESSION_ID`, `BRIDGE_SESSION_ID`, `MESSAGING_SOCKET`, `MESSAGING_TOKEN`, `ENTRYPOINT`, `EXECPATH`, `SESSION_ATTENDED`, `SSE_PORT`); the user's own, such as `CLAUDE_CODE_OAUTH_TOKEN`, stay. It looks for `claude` only in the absolute folders on `PATH`: Windows would look in the current folder first, which is the project. The prompt follows `--`, so it can't be read as an option.

`ListClaudeSessions` reads Claude Code's registry of running sessions, `~/.claude/sessions/<pid>.json` (`$CLAUDE_CONFIG_DIR/sessions` when that is set). Claude Code doesn't document it; nouez reads `pid`,

`sessionId`, `cwd`, `name`, `status`, `kind` (only `interactive` entries count), `procStart` and `bridgeSessionId` (Remote Control), and skips entries it can't parse. A file can outlive its process, and a pid can be reused, so on Windows an entry counts only while its process runs and was created at the recorded `procStart` (`GetProcessTimes`); an entry without a valid `procStart` doesn't count. Elsewhere, an entry counts while the pid exists. A session whose parent process is the `server.py claude` helper, created before it, was opened by `OpenClaudeSession`.

On Windows, `CloseClaudeSession` opens handles to the session's process and its helper and checks their creation times again; while the handles are open, neither pid can pass to another process. For a helper's session it leaves an empty file, `<temp>/nouez-closed-<pid>`, which tells the helper the end was intended, so it exits with code 0 and Windows Terminal closes the window. Then:

Closing a session (Windows)

```
taskkill /PID 20964 /T /F    (claude and its children: shells, MCP servers)
wait up to 5 s for it to end, else TerminateProcess; an error if it is still running
wait up to 3 s for the helper to exit, else TerminateProcess(helper, exit code 0)
```

Closing a session (macOS, Linux)

```
kill -TERM 20964            (then wait up to 5 s for it to end; an error if it doesn't)
```

On Windows, nouez refuses to close any of its own ancestor processes, which include the Claude Code session it serves. Elsewhere it knows only its parent process (`os.getppid`), so a wrapper between Claude Code and nouez would hide the caller from that check.

Trust

Claude Code asks whether the user trusts a folder the first time it runs there, and records the answer in its state file, `~/.claude.json` (in `$CLAUDE_CONFIG_DIR` when that is set), as `hasTrustDialogAccepted = true` in the folder's entry under `projects`, with forward slashes in the folder's name on Windows. Claude Code's documentation gives the rule nouez follows: outside a git repository, trust on a folder covers the folders inside it, except git repositories; in a repository, trust is recorded for the repository's root, and for a linked worktree, its main checkout's root. nouez finds that from the worktree's `.git` file (`gitdir:`) and the `commondir` file in that git folder: when the common git folder is a folder's `.git` directory and that folder holds more than it, the folder is taken as the main checkout. A separate git folder (`-separate-git-dir`) records no link back to its checkout, and can itself be named `.git`, so a common folder named otherwise, or a `.git` alone in its folder, means the trust is unknown. A separate `.git` kept beside other files would still be taken for a checkout, as `git worktree list` takes it too. A submodule is its own repository. So a trusted `C:/Users/me/Projects` covers `Projects/notes` but not the repository `Projects/nouez`. A state file that is missing or can't be parsed also means nouez doesn't know.

With `trust: true` nouez sets that one value, for the folder above, and nothing else. It refuses the home folder, a drive's root and Claude Code's own folder (where Claude Code doesn't keep trust), and a key it can't place. It reads the file and parses it, adding a `projects` table if there is none; a file it can't read or parse, whose `projects` isn't a table, or whose entry for the folder isn't one, is left alone. It checks that the changed JSON reads back equal to what it means to write (a number too big for a float, or text that can't be written as UTF-8, means it leaves the file alone), then copies the file as read to a new dated backup in its own folder (`%LOCALAPPDATA%\nouez\claude-json-backups` on Windows, `$XDG_STATE_HOME` or `~/.local/state` elsewhere; a relative one is ignored; created private), reads the copy back, and keeps the newest 20. Just before replacing the file it reads it again: if a session has written it in the meantime, it starts over from that version (three tries). The new text goes to a temporary file of its own beside the state file and is moved into place in one step; half a second later nouez reads the trust back.

That narrows the risk but can't remove it. Every running Claude Code session rewrites the state file, with the user's MCP servers and project settings in it, and nothing outside Claude Code can lock it, so a session saving in the instant between nouez's last check and its replace could lose that change, and a session that rewrites the file from what it read earlier could drop nouez's. The read-back catches the second; the backups are there for the first.

7 Limits and constants

Constant	Value	Meaning
PROTOCOL_VERSIONS	2025-11-25, 2025-06-18, 2025-03-26	MCP versions answered
SANDBOX	`read-only`	sandbox of every started consultant
BRIDGE_SOURCE	`nouez`	`threadSource` tag on started sessions
POLL_SECONDS	1.5 s	turn polling interval
PROGRESS_SECONDS	10 s	least time between progress notifications
MAX_WAIT_SECONDS	4 h	cap on polling for a turn, `wait: "done"` included
MAX_REPLY_CHARS	60,000	longer replies are cut and saved to a file
PARTIAL_CHARS	4,000	output so far shown for a running turn (the end)
RECENT_SAVED_THREADS	50	saved sessions checked for unloaded consultants
REPLY_LOOKBACK	100	turns searched for a `turn_id`
MAX_FRAME_BYTES	64 MiB	largest WebSocket message accepted
Daemon request timeout	15 s	per Codex request and for the handshake
`roots/list` timeout	5 s	then nouez assumes no roots
Default `wait`	5 s / 0 s	SendConsultantMessage / GetConsultantReply
DAEMON_START_SECONDS	20 s	wait for a daemon nouez started to accept connections
WAITER_REPLY_CHARS	20,000	longest reply the waiter prints
WAITER_RETRIES	3	failed connections the waiter rides out
WAITER_SECONDS	25 min	one waiter run, under Claude Code's limit